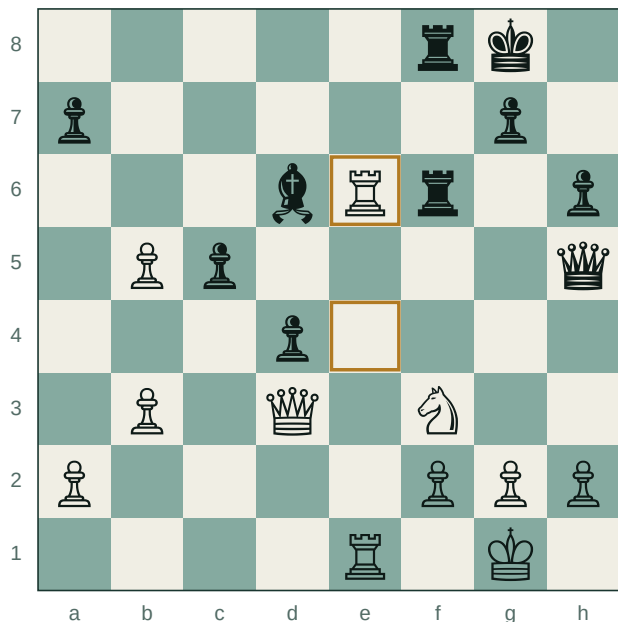


Interference tactics: Black, move 22

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 22.Rxe6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22...Rxf3 23. gxf3 Qxh2+ 24. Kf1 Qh3+ 25. Ke2 Qxe6+

22...Rxf3 The rook captures the knight on f3. Recorded reply: **23.gxf3**.

23...Qxh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h2. Recorded reply: **24.Kf1**.

24...Qh3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From h3 it attacks king on f1 and rook on e6. Recorded reply: **25.Ke2**.

25...Qxe6+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on e6.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 22 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -1 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on d3. Check for tactical protection.